

CONNECTION BETWEEN THE INCARNATORY PROCESSES AND THE LIFE TASK

Greetings, my beloved friends. You all float in a safe cloud of divine consciousness, and you are nurtured by divine love whether you know it, feel it, and experience it, or not. Your total consciousness knows it. Your fragmented consciousness does not. Try to connect with your inner being so that you will know this to be true.

In tonight's lecture I will deal with aspects of the incarnatory process. At this time of your development on your path, this understanding will be again exactly what you need in order to tie up certain realizations and insights you have gained. Again, to begin with, I have to recapitulate certain aspects and facets of creation which I have discussed previously in different contexts. Creation is the attempt of divine reality to fill the void with life and being. There was a whole lecture dedicated to this topic, and I recommend that you reread it in order to fully understand this topic. Fragmented consciousness is a result of the total consciousness spreading and filling every nook and cranny of "space." I use this term again for lack of a better word.

The human structure itself represents this picture very well. Inwardly, deep inside your nucleus is an unending essence. This essence is eternal life, eternal reality, eternal beauty, limitless wisdom and love, but your outer consciousness is not knowingly connected with it. Although it is connected with the essence, your outer consciousness ignores this fact and seems to be disconnected from it. You seem to be an isolated "piece of consciousness;" this is what makes life appear so frightening. Therefore your outer consciousness is groping, is blind. It must seek its way back to its connection with the total self. Awareness must be gained in the outer consciousness of this connection because this connection was really never broken. It only seemed broken from the vantage point of the limited outer consciousness.

Now, it is the task of every fragmented, apparently disconnected aspect of consciousness to realize its true identity and connection with the real self. This happens through an often laborious groping, searching, and attempts of the mind to expand its own narrow limitations. The mind holds this potential of expansion, for even in its disconnected state it contains every aspect of divine reality. It only depends on which way it turns, which way the will directs it, which thought it chooses in any given instant. This is an important key, my friends, and we shall return to it later in this lecture.

These fragmented aspects of consciousness, of divine light which seem to have lost their connection float around in space. These aspects become personalities. These personalities develop problems because of the apparent disconnection. The word problem is in accord with today's vocabulary.

In different periods of history different words were used, like sinfulness, for example. Whatever word you choose, the fragmented aspect of consciousness needs purification on many levels such as feelings, understanding, knowledge. It needs to spread its awareness to its full capacity. Spreading means to realize that the connection exists, has always existed, and will always exist.

A total entity, a complete entity is one who is completely aware of its divine nature, who is in total possession of divine wisdom and energy. You are all total entities, but your manifest consciousness with which you identify is an aspect that your total entity, your total being, seeks to reunite with. This can happen only when this fragmented aspect of your manifest consciousness makes itself compatible with the nature of the total consciousness.

Life, in its broader sense, is very much concerned with the process of spreading divine consciousness and reuniting with apparently disconnected aspects. That process is often called the divine plan or the evolutionary plan or the plan of salvation. There are many different terms to indicate that process. It is an ongoing process. It is a ceaseless movement. It is a ceaseless, flowing energy that seeks to spread out and, at the same time, to reunify itself. In this spreading out, the connection is sometimes apparently lost. So the movement is one of spreading out and moving "back" to its source for reunification, forever more advancing in this back-and-forth flow. Each reunification movement back to the source follows a spreading out process so that the unified substance has meanwhile become enlarged. Just visualize it: spreading out and coming back to the source, spreading out and coming back, each time making the unified substance wider, extending it forever more. That is, in different terms, the great plan.

Now how does this look in a smaller framework of understanding more suited to your human state of consciousness? I will explain it so that you can perhaps derive some benefit from understanding your repeated cycles of life. You have heard many explanations about reincarnation and about the plans you make before you undertake an embodiment. You have heard it mentioned that you make a contract with yourself in order to fulfill a certain task. This planning is conducted in the world of spirit. I shall speak about this now in a slightly different manner.

When you are not embodied, when you are aware of your total being, you are also aware of those aspects in you that have remained untended and need healing and purification. It can also be said that a process of re-education is needed in which new -- in actuality very old -- knowledge is to be gained. This goes parallel to purifying the feeling into the pure love of the essence. Now, in order to follow through the process of spreading, on the one hand, and reunification, on the other, the aspect to be purified is, for lack of a better word, "sent out," as it were, into a realm of consciousness that is commensurate with its own state. And that is the material level of life, as you know it in your conscious being. This realm of existence is the expression of the limited state of consciousness of the disconnected aspect -- the personality -- and in this more ignorant and less aware state, all vibratory functions of life are grossly slowed down. The flow of energy rigidifies and makes things and people fixed. The flow becomes invisible. The same with the entity itself. It is invisible and only the grossly condensed form of its essence appears as the sole reality.

In this state of existence, the process I described can continue. The grosser matter becomes more and more refined as more personalities refine their vibratory functions and their power of perception and awareness. An incarnation is thus chosen in order to fulfill specific tasks in a vast

overall plan. The fragmented aspects have certain basic states in common. When divine perfection has undergone the distortion that temporarily alters its manifestation into a lesser expression, then distortion, misconceptions, suffering, darkness, and disconnection seem to be the common lot of all those apparently isolated personalities. The combinations vary, the degree of development varies, but there are basic components applicable to the divine substance with all its myriad variations, as well as to its distorted version. In other words, one purified being may be totally different from another purified being, each representing a different aspect of divinity. Yet there are unalterable basic common denominators such as love, wisdom, beauty, etc. The same principle holds true in regard to the unpurified personality. Thus, each entity makes different dispositions. It deals differently with the fragmented aspect that needs to be refined. The incarnations are being figured out by the total entity in conjunction with specialized, highly developed beings. The plans are carefully drawn.

What happens in the body has one common denominator for all: to find the reunification with essence. No matter how different the tasks may be, according to necessity this goal remains the same for all. Reunification with the essence can occur where the entity is already purified, but that is not where the task is, of course. The task lies always where the personality is still separate from the essence. It is then up to the conscious mind to decide whether or not it will use the already purified aspects to help the unpurified part in the task fulfillment. This decision must be made by the conscious ego. The higher self will not and cannot force it upon the conscious mind. This would be against all spiritual law. The task is not being fulfilled if all emphasis is put on the already existing and functioning connection with the divine self, without focusing it on the problem aspects, on the blind spots. I spoke about this in several ways. However, in this lecture I want to point to the process of connection in regard to birth and death from the human standpoint.

Let us take the process of death first in this sequence. Birth will be better understood as a sequence of death rather than the way you choose to look at it. Man sees birth as the beginning and death as the end. Hence, from this disconnected view, starting with death may seem senseless. But you will see that birth can only be properly understood if seen as a sequence to death -- or, rather, to the manner death did occur. I do not mean here the superficial circumstances. I mean the fulfillment of the task of the foregoing life which is reflected in the manner of death.

The dying process can take many different forms which vary and which are dependent on the task fulfillment of the personality. When the inner being permeates the outer personality, the task will be fulfilled. In this case the human personality will not only have lived a very full life, but the fluid and the energy streamings of the divine entity withdraw very gradually. The energy recedes, the life forces pull inward into the real, eternal, infinite world, into the infinite space of creation. This causes a slow, late, and organic deterioration as far as the body is concerned. When full fulfillment has been accomplished, the process is so organic, so natural that there is no fear or pain involved. The personality has developed a very strong sense of the continuum of all life. Thus there is no contraction or fear that can cause suffering and pain. Life is an organic and meaningful process for the soul which fulfills the task of the planned contract. Dying and death of the physical matter is equally meaningful. It is but another step of liberation and unfoldment. It is not traumatic. When death comes, it is not feared, nor is it wished as the final escape from the difficulties of life -- difficulties that are not meaningful and are not resolved as a consequence of the personality's stubbornness against opening and against setting the mind into a different direction. In the truly fulfilled life, difficulties are increasingly treated as stepping stones, doors to yet new liberations and

finally cease to be experienced as difficulties. So when neither fear nor wishful desire to escape occupies the personality's energy system, a unity between inner and outer being strives organically toward further and further completion of the great plan in which every aspect of consciousness plays an important role. As the physical and biological life forces recede from the body, only fuller life emerges. But this only occurs, my friends, when the personality learns to tune in to the inner being and follow its guidance and is in harmony with it as a result of concentrating on the aspect of the soul that is to be purified. Then, and then only, are the inner and outer being in full concordance about everything, including the time and the manner of severing the ties with the physical vehicle. In such cases, as the life forces recede from the body, only more and fuller life takes place, and the entity can spread out again in its glory and freedom, unimpeded by the shackles of three-dimensional reality. This awareness exists in the manifesting personality, which is but an aspect of the full being you are. I repeat: this applies to the ideal instances of total task fulfillment. I hope that all of you who are on your path toward this total task fulfillment will follow through sufficiently to reach that state of awareness and connection way before your inner being has decided that the time is completed because you have accomplished what you have set out to do.

In this connection I would like to interject here that there are people who have a deep misconception and distortion in them which prevents them from full commitment to their task fulfillment. It is the idea that if they really resolve their problems and eliminate their darkness and thus become happy and fulfilled, then they must die. The way they visualize dying is, of course, not at all in this harmonious, productive, and meaningful process I described, which must be the natural by-product of purification, fulfillment, and connection. Dying is feared as a disconnected, disharmonious process. Moreover, it is, of course, utterly false to assume that the moment your problems are resolved, your life is finished. Quite the contrary is true. In fact, only when your problems are resolved can a new aspect of task fulfillment begin. For no personality can go through life without letting others benefit from what it has learned. The need, the urge, and the longing to give out are an integral part of the soul and come from the inner entity. Thus the full life that unfolds after the bulk of clouds in the soul has been dissolved is part of the task fulfillment. So, please, do not hold back your progress, my friends, because you consider suffering and unfulfillment of the soul as the only agents that keep you connected with your body. Such thoughts may not be quite conscious and articulate, but they nevertheless exist in a vague way.

Your awareness of and your connection with the inner, real self will make life glorious, and so death will be experienced as glorious. That state of consciousness will make life fearless because there is nothing to fear in dying. Such fearlessness is the ultimate development of each human soul. That is the goal you are trying to reach.

But now let us look at various other possibilities in regard to the process of dying. Those who do not totally fulfill their task in life must feel throughout their lives a vague longing, a tagging, a discontent that cannot be placed. This should always be heeded as a sign that something is amiss, and the conscious mind should start searching deliberately. Incidentally, this also happens on and off to those who are basically committed to such a path. There are new phases coming out of the soul which the conscious mind at first has trouble to understand and recognize. The vague discontent and anxiety are a definite sign that something is missed. Only when the full meaning has been understood and the sign heeded, will the personality find itself once again in a state of deep contentment, inner peace, joy, and security. But those who refuse to seek throughout their lives in the real direction will and must feel the tagging and the whispering of the inner being into the outer

consciousness. The personality then attempts to squelch this voice, to escape from it, to produce a lot of superficial noise and movement so as not to heed the inner voice. The vague discontent is often taken to be the neurosis itself as if the absence of this experience, without changing the life direction, would indicate emotional health. In reality, neurosis is being produced as a result of not establishing the connection with the inner self, as a result of not fulfilling the contract the soul has come to carry out.

I want to draw your attention to another important point that often leads to misunderstandings. Total fulfillment of the life task is not necessarily contingent on higher states of development. It does not always follow. It is very possible that a fragmentary personality aspect embodied in a physical vehicle is not highly developed at all. Nevertheless this personality fulfills its task completely. The task is of course less taxing and commensurate with the possibilities of such a human individual. At the same time, the fact that it is "easier" only holds true relatively in that this task is just as difficult for this particular individual as the much more taxing task is for a higher developed person. The gauge with which to measure the completion of the task is inner peace and fearlessness and organic living and dying. On the other hand, we may have someone who is much more highly developed, but who limps behind his potentiality to develop and fulfill himself and his task. Therefore he will not be in peace. He will be in fear, and his death will not be the organic process I described. So be sure to understand, my friends, that task fulfillment, organic life and death, connectedness, and inner peace are not necessarily a result of higher development. The higher developed person often has more difficulty in bringing the divergent aspects of his soul together, and therefore his struggle may sometimes be a much fiercer one. Also, the less developed person will not have the conscious awareness of the connection with the inner voice. With him it will be more an instinctive phenomenon.

Anyone who is on a path such as this and who makes a total commitment to truth, to self-facing, to self-purification, to giving up all defenses and all subterfuges in order to face that which seems most difficult and momentarily painful; anyone who chooses to forego the temptation to concentrate on the real or apparent wrong of others so as to avoid the self, and who is thus committed to his growth above and beyond all other considerations in his life, will and must make the connection that will then also bring all outer and inner fulfillment.

For your elucidation, let us now make several distinctions about the process of dying. In addition to the ideal case described above, there are other possibilities which occur when the connection between the inner and the outer self is not yet a working bridge.

What happens when death comes when there is a division between the outer and the inner self, the higher self and the outer ego personality, the will of the divine self and the will of the conscious mind? Here, too, several possibilities exist. For example, if the personality very stubbornly refuses the influx of the inner, divine consciousness, refuses the guidance, refuses to heed the signs, takes it upon itself to follow the line of least resistance and rationalizes it; in such instances the outer personality goes more and more away from the possibility of fulfilling the task for which it has come. Series of choices in the wrong direction have set the grooves so deeply that to retrace the steps becomes almost impossible after a certain point has been reached. Negative creative processes have set a spiral configuration in motion consisting of repeated psychic nuclear points, each unleashing their energy force. When the momentum has advanced beyond certain points, the effort and the investment required to dissolve these negative creations while still in the

body by far exceeds the energy and investment necessary when the vehicle is changed, when different "stage settings" have been chosen. Now mind you, my friends, this is by no means always true. There are many, many instances when it is quite possible to change a groove deeply engraved for considerable time, even in advanced human age. When this point of no return has been reached and when not, no conscious mind can possibly evaluate. Only the deeper divine mind can do so. Only one thing is sure. The further away you go, the harder it becomes to turn. To avoid all possible misunderstandings, I say to you that any individual who has reached this point of no return would not even venture anywhere near a path such as this. So let no one believe that he may be one of those simply because he finds himself at the moment in a deep struggle or in a temporary feeling of hopelessness. These manifestations merely bring out what has been there anyway and what needs to reach the surface so as to be dissolved. That is part of the task fulfillment. Anyone who is within the circumference of such a path has the possibility to change the configuration of a negative psychic nuclear spiral.

In cases where the person has veered so much away from the plan the entity has intended for the personality that a new direction, a new spiral form, is impossible to establish; the inner being may make a decision for death. The higher self knows that to continue in the established direction is waste, the suffering pointless, and the fragmented personality aspect better served by starting it all over again. In such instances, death is not organic in its manifestation, but it is meaningful under the particular circumstances and thus organic in its larger context. When I say it is not organic in its manifestation, I mean that death may occur in sudden accidents or illnesses, in painful slow illnesses, and, above all, with the conscious mind completely disconnected from the inner will. The conscious mind may battle against the inner decision, may not understand, and contract against its own inner disposition, thus splitting itself further apart, widening the disconnection. Fear and self-will take over and make inner listening impossible. Premature death, violent death, young people dying in wars often fall into this category, although not always. Nothing can be generalized. But when death occurs in contraction and fear, it is an inorganic manifestation even though it is organic in its disposition from the higher self. In these instances of dying, the outer personality is totally unaware of the decision of the inner self, and that makes the process of dying all the more difficult and painful because it seems senseless and arbitrary. The outer consciousness will then struggle against death and not know that its greater total consciousness has chosen, as a better solution than staying, something that is best under the particular prevailing circumstances.

In such circumstances, when the outer personality fights against what the inner being has decided, a tremendous struggle ensues. That struggle may be carried through even into old age because the outer personality uses its energies and its life forces in order to battle the inner decision. At times, the decision of the inner entity may deliberately outweigh the will of the outer person. Its powers are, of course, infinitely greater than powers available to the outer consciousness. But under other circumstances, the struggle may go on, and the inner self may go into the direction of discontinuing the old setting in order to establish a new one, without however over-exerting its powers, and allowing the outer self to some extent to keep the battle going for a certain amount of time. The reason for that may be that the soul may learn in the agony of such a struggle at least some important lessons which can then be utilized in the next scene. In these cases, a life-or-death struggle -- literally -- is taking place inside. On one level the struggle is against dying. On another level, the struggle is for task fulfillment, for going into the inner direction of seeking and finding out where attention, emphasis, and labor in self-work are most needed in the personality so that the outer person can focus totally on certain areas that have been ignored and negated, areas which

bring up the agonizing struggle in the first place. Another frequent way of ignoring what most needs to be looked at is by seeking spiritual paths that do not put emphasis on this aspect of self-work. This is a convenient way to delude and deceive the self because "spiritual development" can become an escape even though spiritual knowledge may be gained, beautiful meditations achieved, and even genuine spiritual experiences about cosmic reality attained for moments. All this can happen without dealing with the areas that give the person the most pain, discomfort, and guilt whether this is consciously experienced or not.

There is still another possibility I would like to discuss here. This is the opposite of the former -- when the inner being decides for death and the outer personality does not know and resists it. The outer personality may indeed be on the whole in a very favorable direction in which every possibility exists for the task fulfillment, for the fulfillment of the contract the entity has made before entering this realm of material manifestation. However, there may be aspects of that outer personality that cause so much trouble, so much struggle, so much resistance in your terms that in spite of the very propitious circumstances, the outer personality does not want to live. The outer person may ignore and not feel the favorable direction because it is so deeply enmeshed with aspects of the problem that the whole view is blurred. For example, if the outer person refuses to give up its stubbornness, the isolated areas to be worked out remain obscure and frightening, and the general mood becomes hopeless although there is no real cause for that. Part of the dishonest "game" may be to aggrandize the suffering just so as not to "give in" and look for new approaches of the mind to view the self and life. The self-perpetuating principle increases the psychic nuclear point into such acceleration that the personality finally believes in the truth of hopelessness. Thus the outer person finds himself unwilling to move although it could move, has every possibility of moving. The inner, real, divine self knows of the very favorable circumstances and is totally in favor of a continued life. But the outer self willfully destroys this life, acting out its worst impulses, acting out its most destructive aspects against all the favorable manifestations of its life.

When this is the case, the personality fragments itself so much that extremely destructive manifestations will take place. In extreme cases, this may lead to suicide. In less extreme cases it leads to all sorts of other negative and destructive manifestations. When life is terminated in any of these ways, the total entity determines the following life, the following circumstances. These circumstances are figured out in a most exacting way that you cannot even imagine. Every smallest detail is part of an exacting and intricate equation in which every possible aspect and possibility is taken into consideration, is figured out, and is in complete logical connection with the total picture: the task to be accomplished as far as purification is concerned; the task to spread helpful influence onto others in a way best suited to the particular entity; the specific assets of the total entity to be brought out in the life manifestation; the greatest dangers and pitfalls; how much risk to take; how many favorable and unfavorable outer influences should exist in the life -- and favorable and unfavorable does not necessarily coincide with "pleasant" and "unpleasant." It requires exacting research to consider and find the fitting environment, parents, siblings, friends, later contacts in life, influence and guidance of one person to the other, and many, many more variables that you cannot possibly envisage. You also must imagine that all other people who make contact with the personality must equally be figured out and all possibilities be taken into consideration. Each contact leaves many possibilities open. Will the individuals involved interact from their higher self? Will the problem areas and the lower self affect one another? How much should the higher self infuse with its guidance and inspiration, its energies and forces? If too much, it becomes pointless and the personality aspect may just as well not have embodied itself in a vehicle. The most intricate

and sophisticated computer of your present day science could never, never figure out all these details. Nothing is left to chance, nothing is haphazard. There is a total plan and picture and an expertise that surpasses human understanding. I said elsewhere, in an early lecture, that an entire sphere or world deals with exactly this task. Highly developed spirit beings are experts in this field, and a hierarchy of beings has as its task to figure out these life plans.

The fluid system of the energy body carries this plan within itself. It is always visible, available, and recognizable. There are no secrets about it. It, in turn, has great energetic and magnetic power. It is the most powerful magnetic field an individual is born with and carries through life. A future embodiment or incarnation is not, and cannot be, arbitrarily chosen. The stage is set as a result of the life plan of the last incarnation. How much was fulfilled and what remains to be done? What contributed to the failures and what to the proper execution? Where may more challenge be needed and where less? The stage is set through the life and death processes which is exactly determined by the life plan. The plan for the future embodiment is determined by the life and death process as outlined in this lecture. Time, place, and circumstances, the exact setting of the stage must be planned painstakingly to fit the total plan. And the plan is the result of the former life and death processes and simultaneously sets the stage for the birth process.

To the degree the life and death process was favorable from the point of view of the total entity, from the point of view of the fulfillment of the contract, to that degree, the future life (future, again, in your terms) will create a greater connectedness with the eternal being that you are. The life forces, divine fluids, and various energy currents of the total entity that you are will infuse the manifesting personality accordingly, that is, to the degree fulfillment and execution of the plan have taken place. Conversely, to the degree you turn away from the task fulfillment, from the inner connection where it is most needed, where it seems most difficult at first -- to that degree you weaken the bridge through which you can be infused with the energies and the consciousness and the currents of eternal life. The future incarnation is then that much more difficult. The outer personality must make all the efforts. It has to gather its own forces in its disconnected state so as to establish the bridge from its own separated place. For that is the inexorable law. Separated consciousness must find its own potentialities to change its own direction, to transcend its limited mind, its narrow confines.

You can apply all this to the lecture I have given about the psychic nuclear points. The beginning has to be set in motion until the creation takes on its own momentum. When the outer personality has finished a series of embodiments in which it has consistently weakened the connection by willfully going into the opposite direction from where it should go, then the connection is so weak that the personality cannot feel its intrinsic connectedness at all and believes itself to be a totally separated being. This is a familiar picture for you. You know many people who do, and even you on the path still often experience yourself in this way. Then the effort needed to reestablish connection, to be more towards the right direction, to seek where it seems most difficult within the black spots is much greater. However, only with this greater effort and good will can the direction be changed. It gradually becomes easier and easier because in the changing of direction a positive force builds up, a new spiral movement and psychic nuclear points start exploding and creating more and more positive manifestations, energies, and momentum. Thus the influx of divine truth, wisdom, power, and love becomes forever greater.

This infusion of energies by the inner being interpenetrating the outer person is directly connected with the willingness to go through with what seems most difficult. This is truly a very simple gauge for you. In that gauge you find all the answers. It is possible for you then to use the already manifest connection with the eternal consciousness so as to open the mind where it is still closed to more and more possibilities. Let us see this in a more specific way. You all know from past experience how easy it is to believe that there is no way out when you are in a tight, difficult spot within yourself. The moment you blindly assume either consciously or unconsciously, either directly through your thinking process or indirectly by the way you act and react in your situation, that there is no other solution but the negative one that gives you hopelessness and pain, you have closed your inner and outer mind to the always existing alternatives and possibilities. First the disconnected, conscious mind must make a deliberate effort and be ready for other possibilities. The conscious mind, as it is now available to you, contains possibilities to widen its scope to see more; to think in different ways; to expand its present limited circumference. This is its task. Without this your goal cannot be accomplished. That is the only way the connection with your greater consciousness can be formed and can then increasingly be more infused with the consciousness and energy system of your total being. This is very important for you to understand, my friends.

Another aspect that is equally important in order to change the tide is the question of identification, which I have also discussed in the past. When you totally identify with the gloom and the doom, you perpetuate the negative creation, and you strengthen the imaginary separation from all that has meaning and that is good. The negative creation, the negative psychic nuclear point makes it more and more difficult for you to find that you are not only that which thinks and feels this hopelessness. So when you are hopeless, it is important to know that you now identify with your hopelessness. When you feel totally self-rejecting, guilty, and bad, it is important to know that you now identify totally with that aspect in you that is unpurified and that hates itself. The moment you know that, it already makes a great deal of difference. You can then go to the next step by asking yourself the question, "Is there not another possibility? Is this really all there is to me? Am I not also something else?" What I mean here is not something that as yet appears remote. You cannot yet experience the reality of your divine self. But even in your conscious mind, are you not also something else? You do have the possibility to see this very situation in a different way, maybe merely by opening your mind to another train of thought you have not yet tried but which you certainly have the capacity of trying out. That means opening the doors of the mind. Opening the doors of the mind is an exceedingly important process in changing the tide because the fragmented aspect of consciousness must find its way back through its own means since it is not aware of its essential connection. And only through its own means, the means of the disconnected mind, can the bridge be established. And as the bridge is being established more and more, you allow the fragmented consciousness to be infused with the powerful, potent energies of your eternal being.

Great blessings are given to everyone of you. Extend love to each other, give love to each other, give sustenance to each other even when you seem to be rejected. Love is needed, perhaps not always in an overt act, but certainly always in feelings. A great, wonderful blessing goes deeper and deeper into you, hallowing your life. Be in peace.

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